

The Guardians (Choose 3-4 based on party strength):

- **Corrupted Celestial:**

Corrupted Celestial *Large celestial, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 17 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 136 (16d10 + 48)
- **Speed** 30 ft., fly 90 ft.
- **STR** 18 (+4) **DEX** 18 (+4) **CON** 17 (+3) **INT** 17 (+3) **WIS** 20 (+5) **CHA** 20 (+5)
- **Saving Throws** Int +9, Wis +11, Cha +11
- **Skills** Insight +11, Perception +11
- **Damage Resistances** necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, frightened
- **Senses** truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 21
- **Languages** all, telepathy 120 ft.
- **Challenge** 10 (5,900 XP)

Spellcasting. The celestial is an 8th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 19, +11 to hit with spell attacks). It knows the following spells:

- **Cantrips (at will):** *light, sacred flame, thaumaturgy*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *cure wounds, detect evil and good*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *lesser restoration, silence*
- **3rd level (3 slots):** *daylight, revivify*
- **4th level (2 slots):** *freedom of movement, guardian of faith*

Magic Resistance. The celestial has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Actions *Multiattack.* The celestial makes two melee attacks.

***Corrupted Touch# The Forgotten Sanctum

A D&D 5th Edition Dungeon Crawl for Characters Level 2-4

Adventure Background

Deep beneath the rolling hills of Greendale Valley lies the Forgotten Sanctum, an ancient temple complex dedicated to Solara, the goddess of knowledge and protection. For centuries, it served as a repository of wisdom and a sanctuary for scholars, until a terrible curse sealed its halls and drove out its guardians. Now, 200 years later, the seals are weakening, and strange lights have been seen emanating from the hillside entrance.

The party has been hired by the village of Millhaven to investigate these phenomena and, if possible, cleanse whatever evil has taken root in the sacred halls. What they'll discover is a complex dungeon filled with ancient puzzles, undead guardians, trapped scholars who became something more than human, and a dark secret that explains why the temple was sealed in the first place.

This is a classic dungeon crawl that emphasizes exploration, puzzle-solving, and tactical combat, perfect for parties looking to test their skills against a variety of challenges in the depths below.

Central Mystery: The temple's high priestess, Lyrlei the Eternal, attempted to achieve immortality through forbidden magic. The ritual partially succeeded but corrupted her and the temple's magic, creating undead guardians and twisted knowledge-seekers. The party must navigate the temple's defenses, solve its ancient puzzles, and confront the corrupted priestess to lift the curse.

Adventure Hooks

- **Village Commission:** The people of Millhaven offer 200 gold pieces to investigate the mysterious lights and ensure their safety
- **Scholarly Interest:** A sage seeks ancient knowledge rumored to be contained in the temple's library
- **Religious Duty:** A cleric or paladin feels called to cleanse the desecrated holy site
- **Personal Quest:** A character has a connection to the temple's history or the goddess Solara

Chapter 1: The Entrance and Upper Levels

Approaching the Sanctum

The Hillside Entrance: *A narrow path winds up the hillside to what appears to be a natural cave mouth, but careful examination reveals worked stone around the edges. Ancient symbols are carved into the rock face, weathered but still legible to those who understand religious iconography. Pale blue light flickers from within, and the air carries a faint scent of ozone and old parchment.*

The Entrance Cavern: *The natural cave opens into a formal entrance hall carved from living rock. Tall pillars support a vaulted ceiling decorated with star charts and celestial symbols. At the far end, a magnificent archway leads deeper into the complex, flanked by statues of robed figures holding books and scrolls.*

Initial Observations:

- **Religion DC 12:** The symbols identify this as a temple to Solara, goddess of knowledge
- **Investigation DC 14:** The statues show signs of recent disturbance, as if they've been moving
- **Perception DC 15:** Faint magical auras emanate from the deeper passages

- **History DC 16:** This matches descriptions of the lost Sanctum of Solara from old texts

Level 1: The Hall of Trials

Room 1A: The Guardian Statues *Two marble statues stand sentinel beside the main passage. As the party approaches, their stone eyes begin to glow with inner light, and they speak in unison: "Who seeks wisdom in the halls of Solara? Prove your worth or turn back now."*

The Challenge: The statues ask three riddles that test different aspects of wisdom:

1. **Knowledge:** "I am not seen, yet I illuminate minds. I grow when shared but never diminish. What am I?" (Answer: Knowledge/Wisdom)
2. **Protection:** "I shield without armor, guard without weapons, and strengthen through sacrifice. What am I?" (Answer: Love/Loyalty/Faith)
3. **Truth:** "I am harder to find than treasure, more valuable than gold, and feared by liars. What am I?" (Answer: Truth)

Consequences:

- **All Correct:** Statues grant blessing (+1 to next three ability checks for each party member)
- **Some Correct:** Statues allow passage but remain neutral
- **All Wrong:** Statues animate and attack as **Stone Golems**:

Stone Golem Guardian *Medium construct, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 16 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 33 (6d8 + 6)
- **Speed** 25 ft.
- **STR** 16 (+3) **DEX** 11 (+0) **CON** 13 (+1) **INT** 1 (-5) **WIS** 3 (-4) **CHA** 1 (-5)
- **Damage Resistances** bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison, psychic
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 6
- **Languages** understands the languages of its creator but can't speak
- **Challenge** 2 (450 XP)

Antimagic Susceptibility. The golem is incapacitated while in the area of an antimagic field.

False Appearance. While motionless, the golem is indistinguishable from a normal statue.

Actions **Slam.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) bludgeoning damage.

Room 1B: The Purification Chamber *A circular chamber with a shallow pool in the center, fed by a spring that bubbles up from the depths. The water glows with soft blue light, and ancient text carved into the walls describes purification rituals.*

The Puzzle: The pool requires an offering of something valuable to each party member before granting its blessing. The offering must be personal and meaningful (a treasured item, a drop of blood, a sincere confession, etc.).

Rewards:

- **Purified Water:** Each character gains 1d4+1 temporary hit points
- **Blessing of Clarity:** Advantage on the next Wisdom save or Investigation check
- **Sacred Knowledge:** The water reveals a vision of the temple's layout

Room 1C: The Archive Antechamber *Tall shelves line the walls, filled with scrolls and tomes that seem to whisper when approached. A circular reading desk sits in the center, upon which rests an open book that glows with magical writing.*

The Magical Book: The *Tome of Seeking* displays different information based on who reads it:

- **Clerics/Paladins:** Locations of remaining blessed areas in the temple
- **Wizards/Sorcerers:** Warnings about magical traps in deeper levels
- **Rogues:** Hidden passages and secret treasure locations
- **Others:** General layout and safer routes through the complex

Environmental Hazards:

- **Whispering Scrolls:** DC 13 Wisdom save or become distracted (disadvantage on Perception for 10 minutes)
- **Unstable Shelves:** Investigate carelessly and shelves collapse (DC 15 Dex save or take 1d6 bludgeoning damage)

Level 1: Combat Encounters

Room 1D: The Defiled Study *Once a peaceful reading room, this chamber now hosts corrupted scholars who refused to leave when the curse took hold. Their forms are gaunt and pale, their eyes glowing with unholy hunger for knowledge.*

Enemies:

- **3 Corrupted Scholars:**

Corrupted Scholar *Medium undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 22 (5d8)

- **Speed** 30 ft.
- **STR** 13 (+1) **DEX** 15 (+2) **CON** 10 (+0) **INT** 16 (+3) **WIS** 12 (+1) **CHA** 14 (+2)
- **Damage Resistances** necrotic
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, poisoned
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11
- **Languages** Common plus any two others
- **Challenge** 1 (200 XP)

Actions ***Draining Touch.*** *Melee Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) necrotic damage. The target must make a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or their hit point maximum is reduced by the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest.

Corrupted Knowledge (Recharge 5-6). The scholar whispers dark secrets. One creature within 30 feet must make a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or be stunned until the end of their next turn as forbidden knowledge overwhelms their mind.

- **1 Knowledge Wraith:**

Knowledge Wraith *Medium undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 22 (5d8)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 1 (-5) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 11 (+0) **INT** 18 (+4) **WIS** 12 (+1) **CHA** 17 (+3)
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** necrotic, poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11
- **Languages** the languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 1 (200 XP)

Incorporeal Movement. The wraith can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the wraith has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions ***Intelligence Drain.*** *Melee Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) necrotic damage. The target must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the target's Intelligence score is reduced by 1d4. The target dies if this reduces its Intelligence to 0. Otherwise, the reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest.

Tactics:

- Scholars attempt to grapple and drain party members
- Knowledge Wraith phases through walls to attack spellcasters
- Both types flee if reduced to 25% HP, retreating to deeper levels

Treasure:

- **Spell Scroll of Detect Magic**
- **Potion of Healing**
- **Scholar's Pack** (includes magnifying glass, book of local history, ink and quill)
- **50 gp** in various coins scattered around the room

Room 1E: The Corrupted Garden *A once-beautiful underground garden where magical light helped plants grow. Now the vegetation has become twisted and aggressive, fed by corrupted magical energy.*

Enemies:

- **2 Corrupted Awakened Shrubs:**

Corrupted Awakened Shrub *Small plant, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 9
- **Hit Points** 10 (3d6)
- **Speed** 20 ft.
- **STR** 3 (-4) **DEX** 8 (-1) **CON** 11 (+0) **INT** 10 (+0) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 6 (-2)
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** fire
- **Damage Resistances** piercing
- **Condition Immunities** blinded, deafened
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** one language known by its creator
- **Challenge** 1/4 (50 XP)

False Appearance. While the shrub remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal shrub.

Actions ***Corrupted Rake.** Melee Weapon Attack:* +1 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 (1d4 - 1) slashing damage plus 2 (1d4) necrotic damage.

- **1 Vine Blight:**

Vine Blight *Medium plant, neutral evil*

- **Armor Class** 12 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 26 (4d8 + 8)

- **Speed** 10 ft.
- **STR** 15 (+2) **DEX** 8 (-1) **CON** 14 (+2) **INT** 5 (-3) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 3 (-4)
- **Skills** Stealth +1
- **Condition Immunities** blinded, deafened
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** Common
- **Challenge** 1/2 (100 XP)

False Appearance. While the blight remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a tangle of vines.

Actions ***Constrict.** Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage, and a Large or smaller target is grappled (escape DC 12). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained, and the blight can't constrict another target.

Entangling Plants (Recharge 5-6). Grasping roots and vines sprout in a 15-foot radius centered on a point within 30 feet of the blight. That area becomes difficult terrain, and each creature there must succeed on a DC 12 Strength saving throw or be restrained by the entangling plants. A creature can use its action to make a DC 12 Strength check, freeing itself or another entangled creature within reach on a success.

- **Poisonous Spores:** Released when plants are damaged (DC 12 Con save or poisoned for 1 hour)

Environmental Features:

- **Overgrown Paths:** Difficult terrain throughout most of the room
- **Hanging Vines:** Can be used for swinging or climbing (DC 12 Athletics/Acrobatics)
- **Magic Fountain:** Still pure, provides fresh water and negates poison conditions

Treasure:

- **Herbalism Kit** hidden among the corrupted plants
- **3 Goodberries** growing on a single uncorrupted bush
- **Silvered Dagger** dropped by a previous adventurer

Chapter 2: Level 2 - The Sacred Libraries

The Grand Library

Room 2A: The Main Reading Hall *A vast chamber with three levels of balconies, all lined with countless books and scrolls. Floating motes of light drift through the air, providing illumination for reading. But something is wrong—many of the books flutter their pages like wounded birds, and the silence is broken by occasional ghostly whispers.*

The Challenge: The library is defended by **Animated Books** that attack intruders while trying to protect the knowledge within.

Enemies:

- **6 Flying Books:**

Flying Book *Tiny construct, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 14 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 2 (1d4)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 50 ft.
- **STR** 4 (-3) **DEX** 18 (+4) **CON** 11 (+0) **INT** 2 (-4) **WIS** 8 (-1) **CHA** 6 (-2)
- **Senses** blindsight 10 ft., passive Perception 9
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1/8 (25 XP)

Keen Sight. The book has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions **Slam.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 1 bludgeoning damage, and the book attaches to the target. While attached, the book flutters around the target's head, imposing disadvantage on attack rolls. The attached book can be removed by the target or another creature as an action.

- **2 Tome Guardians:**

Tome Guardian *Medium construct, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 18 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 33 (6d8 + 6)
- **Speed** 25 ft.
- **STR** 14 (+2) **DEX** 11 (+0) **CON** 13 (+1) **INT** 1 (-5) **WIS** 3 (-4) **CHA** 1 (-5)
- **Damage Resistances** bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't adamantine
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** fire
- **Damage Immunities** force, necrotic, poison
- **Condition Immunities** blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 6
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1 (200 XP)

Antimagic Susceptibility. The guardian is incapacitated while in the area of an antimagic field.

False Appearance. While motionless, the guardian is indistinguishable from a pile of books.

Actions *Slam.* *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Paper Cut Whirlwind (Recharge 5-6). The guardian releases a whirlwind of sharp paper. Each creature within 10 feet must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 7 (2d6) slashing damage on a failed save, or half as much on a successful one.

- **1 Spectral Librarian:**

Spectral Librarian *Medium undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 58 (13d8)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 1 (-5) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 10 (+0) **INT** 17 (+3) **WIS** 13 (+1) **CHA** 18 (+4)
- **Saving Throws** Wis +4, Cha +7
- **Damage Resistances** acid, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** cold, necrotic, poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11
- **Languages** Common, plus any languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP)

Incorporeal Movement. The librarian can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Actions *Corrupting Touch.* *Melee Spell Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) necrotic damage.

Horrifying Wail (1/Day). The librarian releases a mournful wail. This wail has no effect on constructs and undead. All other creatures within 30 feet that can hear the librarian must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, a creature drops to 0 hit points. On a success, a creature takes 10 (3d6) psychic damage. The wail only affects creatures that have damaged books in the library.

Library Features:

- **Floating Platforms:** Magical discs that can be activated to reach higher shelves (Arcana DC 13)
- **Card Catalog:** Massive magical index that can locate any book instantly (requires 10 minutes to use)
- **Reading Alcoves:** Small spaces that provide cover and temporary sanctuary
- **Skylight Wells:** Openings to the surface that provide natural light and fresh air

Knowledge Rewards: Characters who spend time researching (1 hour, Investigation DC 15) can discover:

- **Temple History:** Learn about High Priestess Lyranei and her immortality experiments
- **Curse Details:** Understand the nature of the corruption and how to potentially cleanse it
- **Hidden Passages:** Locations of secret doors and alternative routes
- **Monster Weaknesses:** Specific information about creatures in deeper levels

The Specialized Collections

Room 2B: The Scroll Vault *A climate-controlled chamber where the most precious documents are stored in crystal cases. However, many cases are now cracked or shattered, and the scrolls within have become aggressive guardians of their own knowledge.*

The Puzzle: The vault's security system requires three different keys to be activated simultaneously:

1. **The Silver Key:** Hidden in a false bottom drawer (Investigation DC 16)
2. **The Crystal Key:** Held by one of the animated scrolls (must be retrieved during combat)
3. **The Star Key:** Appears only when the constellation on the ceiling is properly aligned (Intelligence DC 14)

Enemies:

- **4 Animated Scrolls:**

Animated Scroll *Tiny construct, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 13
- **Hit Points** 5 (2d4)
- **Speed** 10 ft., fly 40 ft.
- **STR** 4 (-3) **DEX** 16 (+3) **CON** 10 (+0) **INT** 10 (+0) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 7 (-2)
- **Damage Immunities** poison, psychic
- **Condition Immunities** blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 10
- **Languages** understands Common but can't speak
- **Challenge** 1/4 (50 XP)

Telepathic Bond. While the scroll is on the same plane of existence as its animator, it can magically convey what it senses to its animator, and the two can communicate telepathically.

Actions ***Fist.** Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. ***Hit:*** 1 bludgeoning damage.

Magic Missile (1/Day). The scroll casts *magic missile* as a 1st-level spell (3 darts, each dealing 1d4 + 1 force damage).

- **Security Construct** (activates if wrong keys are used):

Security Construct *Small construct, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 17 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 52 (8d8 + 16)
- **Speed** 30 ft.
- **STR** 16 (+3) **DEX** 11 (+0) **CON** 15 (+2) **INT** 7 (-2) **WIS** 11 (+0) **CHA** 3 (-4)
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned
- **Senses** blindsight 10 ft., darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** understands Common but can't speak
- **Challenge** 2 (450 XP)

Bound. The construct is magically bound to the vault. If the construct moves more than 100 feet from the vault, it is destroyed.

Regeneration. The construct regains 10 hit points at the start of its turn if it has at least 1 hit point and is within the vault.

Actions ***Multiattack.*** The construct makes two fist attacks.

Fist. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. ***Hit:*** 6 (1d6 + 3) bludgeoning damage.

Healing Spell (3/Day). The construct casts *cure wounds* as a 2nd-level spell (+7 to hit with spell attacks, spell save DC 13).

Vault Treasure:

- **Spell Scrolls:** *Cure Wounds, Shield, Misty Step*
- **Manual of History:** Provides advantage on History checks for one month
- **Map of the Temple:** Reveals all rooms and passages on current level
- **Sanctified Oil:** 3 vials, each turns one weapon silvered for 24 hours

Room 2C: The Forbidden Section *Heavy chains and warning symbols mark this area as containing dangerous knowledge. The books here whisper dark secrets and radiate an aura of malevolent intelligence.*

The Temptation: Characters who read the forbidden books must make Wisdom saves or gain dark knowledge with consequences:

- **DC 10:** Learn a random cantrip but gain a minor curse (food tastes like ash for 1 week)

- **DC 13:** Discover the location of a major treasure but age 1 year permanently
- **DC 16:** Gain insight into the final boss's weakness but must save vs. temporary madness

Guardians:

- **2 Dark Scholars:**

Dark Scholar *Medium undead, neutral evil*

- **Armor Class** 14 (Studded Leather)
- **Hit Points** 45 (6d12 + 12)
- **Speed** 30 ft.
- **STR** 15 (+2) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 16 (+3) **INT** 18 (+4) **WIS** 13 (+1) **CHA** 15 (+2)
- **Saving Throws** Con +6, Wis +4
- **Skills** Arcana +7, History +7, Perception +4
- **Damage Resistances** necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, poisoned
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14
- **Languages** the languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 3 (700 XP)

Spellcasting. The dark scholar is a 5th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). It knows the following spells:

- **Cantrips (at will):** *mage hand, minor illusion, prestidigitation*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *magic missile, shield*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *hold person, misty step*
- **3rd level (2 slots):** *counterspell, fireball*

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the scholar has disadvantage on attack rolls and Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions **Life Drain.** *Melee Spell Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) necrotic damage. The target must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw, taking 5 (2d4) necrotic damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. The scholar regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.

- **Whispering Shadows:**

Whispering Shadow *Medium undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 16 (3d8 + 3)
- **Speed** 40 ft.

- **STR** 6 (-2) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 13 (+1) **INT** 10 (+0) **WIS** 12 (+1) **CHA** 14 (+2)
- **Skills** Stealth +4 (+6 in dim light or darkness)
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** radiant
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** necrotic, poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1/2 (100 XP)

Amorphous. The shadow can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Shadow Stealth. While in dim light or darkness, the shadow can take the Hide action as a bonus action.

Sunlight Weakness. While in sunlight, the shadow has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws.

Actions *Wisdom Drain.* *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) necrotic damage, and the target's Wisdom score is reduced by 1d4. The target dies if this reduces its Wisdom to 0. Otherwise, the reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. If a non-evil humanoid dies from this attack, a new shadow rises from the corpse 1d4 hours later.

Forbidden Knowledge Rewards:

- **Ritual of Unbinding:** Method to break magical curses and barriers
- **True Name:** The corrupted priestess's real identity and history
- **Weakness Revealed:** How to damage creatures normally immune to physical attacks
- **Secret Passage:** Direct route to the final level, bypassing some dangers

Chapter 3: Level 3 - The Ritual Chambers

The Preparation Halls

Room 3A: The Alchemical Laboratory *Bubbling beakers, ancient apparatus, and preserved specimens fill this chamber where the priestess conducted her immortality experiments. Many containers have cracked or exploded, leaving dangerous residues throughout the room.*

Environmental Hazards:

- **Toxic Fumes:** DC 12 Constitution save each round or take 1d4 poison damage
- **Unstable Chemicals:** Loud noises or fire damage cause explosions (2d6 fire damage, 10-foot radius)

- **Slippery Surfaces:** Spilled potions create difficult terrain and require Dexterity saves to avoid falling

Encounters:

- **3 Poison Sprites:**

Poison Sprite *Tiny fey, chaotic neutral*

- **Armor Class** 15 (Leather Armor)
- **Hit Points** 2 (1d4)
- **Speed** 10 ft., fly 40 ft.
- **STR** 3 (-4) **DEX** 18 (+4) **CON** 10 (+0) **INT** 14 (+2) **WIS** 13 (+1) **CHA** 11 (+0)
- **Skills** Perception +3, Stealth +8
- **Senses** passive Perception 13
- **Languages** Common, Elvish, Sylvan
- **Challenge** 1/4 (50 XP)

Actions ***Poison Dart.** Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, range 20/60 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 1 piercing damage, and the target must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 1 minute. If its saving throw result is 5 or lower, the poisoned target falls unconscious for the same duration, or until it takes damage or another creature takes an action to shake it awake.

Heart Sight. The sprite touches a creature and magically knows the creature's current emotional state. If the target fails a DC 10 Charisma saving throw, the sprite also knows the creature's alignment. Celestials, fiends, and undead automatically fail the saving throw.

Invisibility. The sprite magically turns invisible until it attacks or casts a spell, or until its concentration ends (as if concentrating on a spell). Any equipment the sprite wears or carries is invisible with it.

- **1 Alchemical Ooze:**

Alchemical Ooze *Medium ooze, unaligned*

- **Armor Class** 8
- **Hit Points** 22 (3d8 + 9)
- **Speed** 10 ft., climb 10 ft.
- **STR** 12 (+1) **DEX** 6 (-2) **CON** 16 (+3) **INT** 1 (-5) **WIS** 6 (-2) **CHA** 2 (-4)
- **Skills** Stealth +2
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, fire
- **Condition Immunities** blinded, charmed, deafened, exhaustion, frightened, prone
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 8
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1/2 (100 XP)

Amorphous. The ooze can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Corrode Metal. Any nonmagical weapon made of metal that hits the ooze corrodes. After dealing damage, the weapon takes a permanent and cumulative -1 penalty to damage rolls. If its penalty drops to -5, the weapon is destroyed. Nonmagical ammunition made of metal is destroyed after hitting the ooze.

False Appearance. While the ooze remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from an oily pool or wet rock.

Acid Healing. When the ooze takes acid damage, it regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.

Actions *Pseudopod.* *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) bludgeoning damage plus 7 (2d6) acid damage, and if the target is wearing nonmagical metal armor, its armor is partly corroded and takes a permanent and cumulative -1 penalty to the AC it offers. The armor is destroyed if the penalty reduces its AC to 10.

- **Animated Equipment** (beakers and tubes):

Animated Beaker *Tiny construct, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 17 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 5 (1d4 + 3)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 4 (-3) **DEX** 18 (+4) **CON** 16 (+3) **INT** 1 (-5) **WIS** 5 (-3) **CHA** 1 (-5)
- **Damage Immunities** poison, psychic
- **Condition Immunities** blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 7
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1/4 (50 XP)

Antimagic Susceptibility. The beaker is incapacitated while in the area of an antimagic field.

False Appearance. While the beaker remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal beaker.

Actions *Glass Shard.* *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

Shatter (1/Day). The beaker explodes in a 5-foot radius. Each creature in the area must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 7 (2d6) piercing damage on a failed save, or half as much on a successful one. The beaker is destroyed.

Laboratory Treasures:

- **Alchemist's Supplies** (masterwork, provides advantage on alchemy checks)
- **4 Potions of Healing**
- **2 Potions of Lesser Restoration**
- **Experimental Elixir:** Unknown effect, requires Arcana DC 15 to identify safely
- **Formula Notes:** Provide clues about the priestess's immortality ritual

Room 3B: The Meditation Circle *A perfectly circular chamber with cushions arranged around a central brazier. The walls are covered in mandalas and sacred geometry that seem to shift when viewed peripherally.*

The Puzzle: The meditation circle tests mental discipline and spiritual focus:

1. **Sit in the circle for 10 minutes** (Wisdom saving throws each minute, starting at DC 10 and increasing by 1)
2. **Maintain concentration** while visions of the temple's history play out
3. **Resist the corruption** that tries to overwhelm the mind with dark knowledge

Success Rewards:

- **Clarity of Mind:** Advantage on all mental saves for the rest of the adventure
- **Spiritual Insight:** Understanding of how to purify corrupted areas
- **Divine Guidance:** Vision showing the safest path to the final chamber

Failure Consequences:

- **Mental Fatigue:** Disadvantage on Wisdom checks for 24 hours
- **Disturbing Visions:** Occasional distractions that impose disadvantage on Perception
- **Corruption Touch:** Healing magic is less effective (heals minimum on dice)

The Inner Sanctum Approach

Room 3C: The Hall of Mirrors *Countless mirrors line the walls, each reflecting not your appearance but your deepest fears, greatest desires, or hidden shames. The reflections sometimes move independently, and some mirrors show scenes from other places and times.*

The Challenge: Navigate through the hall without being trapped by the mirror illusions:

- **Wisdom (Insight) DC 14:** Distinguish between real and false reflections
- **Charisma (Deception) DC 15:** Convince your reflection to help rather than hinder
- **Strength (Athletics) DC 13:** Break through mirror barriers when all else fails

Mirror Effects (Random when touched or gazed into for more than 1 round):

1. **Fear Mirror:** Wisdom save DC 13 or frightened for 1 minute
2. **Desire Mirror:** Charisma save DC 14 or charmed by illusion for 10 minutes
3. **Truth Mirror:** Forces honesty for next 10 minutes but provides advantage on Insight

4. **Time Mirror:** Shows past or future events related to the temple
5. **Escape Mirror:** Allows teleportation to any other mirror in the room
6. **Shatter Mirror:** Explodes for 2d6 slashing damage in 5-foot radius

Hidden Treasures:

- **Mirror Shield:** +1 shield that can reflect gaze attacks back at attackers
- **Cloak of Displacement:** Appears to be hanging in one of the mirrors
- **Ring of Mind Shielding:** Hidden behind a mirror that shows the wearer's true thoughts

Chapter 4: Level 4 - The Corrupted Sanctum

The Final Approaches

Room 4A: The Guardian Chamber *Six alcoves ring this circular chamber, each containing a different type of guardian that once protected the inner sanctum. Now they serve the corrupted priestess, their holy purpose twisted into dark loyalty.*

The Guardians (Choose 3-4 based on party strength):

- **Corrupted Celestial:**

Corrupted Celestial *Large celestial, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 17 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 136 (16d10 + 48)
- **Speed** 30 ft., fly 90 ft.
- **STR** 18 (+4) **DEX** 18 (+4) **CON** 17 (+3) **INT** 17 (+3) **WIS** 20 (+5) **CHA** 20 (+5)
- **Saving Throws** Int +9, Wis +11, Cha +11
- **Skills** Insight +11, Perception +11
- **Damage Resistances** necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, frightened
- **Senses** truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 21
- **Languages** all, telepathy 120 ft.
- **Challenge** 10 (5,900 XP)

Spellcasting. The celestial is an 8th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 19, +11 to hit with spell attacks). It knows the following spells:

- **Cantrips (at will):** *chill touch, minor illusion, thaumaturgy*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *inflict wounds, detect evil and good*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *hold person, silence*
- **3rd level (3 slots):** *darkness, counterspell*
- **4th level (2 slots):** *confusion, freedom of movement*

Magic Resistance. The celestial has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Actions Multiattack. The celestial makes two melee attacks.

Corrupted Touch. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 20 (3d10 + 4) necrotic damage.

Healing Touch (3/Day). The celestial touches another creature. The target magically regains 15 (2d8 + 6) hit points and is freed from any curse, disease, poison, blindness, or deafness.

- **Bound Earth Elemental:**

Bound Earth Elemental *Medium elemental, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 17 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 63 (6d12 + 24)
- **Speed** 30 ft., burrow 30 ft.
- **STR** 18 (+4) **DEX** 8 (-1) **CON** 18 (+4) **INT** 5 (-3) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 5 (-3)
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** thunder
- **Damage Resistances** bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, unconscious
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** Terran
- **Challenge** 3 (700 XP)

Earth Glide. The elemental can burrow through nonmagical, unworked earth and stone. While doing so, the elemental doesn't disturb the material it moves through.

Siege Monster. The elemental deals double damage to objects and structures.

Actions Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage.

Earth Tremor (Recharge 5-6). The elemental strikes the ground, creating a localized tremor. All other creatures within 15 feet must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage and is knocked prone. On a successful save, the creature takes half damage and isn't knocked prone.

- **Spectral Knight:**

Spectral Knight *Medium undead, lawful evil*

- **Armor Class** 14 (Studded Leather)
- **Hit Points** 45 (6d12 + 12)

- **Speed** 30 ft.
- **STR** 15 (+2) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 16 (+3) **INT** 10 (+0) **WIS** 13 (+1) **CHA** 15 (+2)
- **Saving Throws** Con +6, Wis +4
- **Skills** Perception +4, Stealth +5
- **Damage Resistances** necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, poisoned
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14
- **Languages** the languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 3 (700 XP)

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the knight has disadvantage on attack rolls and Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Spellcasting. The knight is a 4th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). It has the following paladin spells prepared:

- **1st level (4 slots):** *command, protection from evil and good*
- **2nd level (2 slots):** *hold person, spiritual weapon*

Actions *Life Drain.* **Melee Weapon Attack:** +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. **Hit:** 5 (1d6 + 2) necrotic damage. The target must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw, taking 5 (2d4) necrotic damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. The knight regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.

Longsword. **Melee Weapon Attack:** +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. **Hit:** 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

- **The Spirits (6 Restless Dead):**

Restless Spirit *Medium undead, chaotic neutral*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 22 (5d8)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 1 (-5) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 11 (+0) **INT** 10 (+0) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 11 (+0)
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** necrotic, poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** any languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 1 (200 XP)

Incorporeal Movement. The spirit can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the spirit has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions Life Drain. *Melee Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) necrotic damage. The target must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the target's hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

Mournful Wail (1/Day). The spirit releases a wail of anguish. Each creature within 30 feet that can hear the spirit must make a DC 11 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened for 1 minute. A frightened target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Lyralei the Eternal (Final Boss) *Medium undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 17 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 112 (15d8 + 45)
- **Speed** 30 ft., fly 60 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 11 (+0) **DEX** 16 (+3) **CON** 16 (+3) **INT** 20 (+5) **WIS** 14 (+2) **CHA** 16 (+3)
- **Saving Throws** Int +10, Wis +7
- **Skills** Arcana +15, History +10, Religion +10
- **Damage Resistances** cold, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison, charmed, exhaustion
- **Condition Immunities** frightened, poisoned
- **Senses** truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 12
- **Languages** Common, Celestial, Abyssal
- **Challenge** 9 (5,000 XP) **Legendary Actions** 2

Spellcasting. Lyralei is a 9th-level spellcaster. Her spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 18, +10 to hit with spell attacks). She knows the following spells:

- **Cantrips (at will):** *chill touch, mage hand, minor illusion, prestidigitation*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *magic missile, shield*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *hold person, misty step*
- **3rd level (3 slots):** *counterspell, fireball*
- **4th level (3 slots):** *confusion, greater invisibility*
- **5th level (1 slot):** *dominate person, scrying*

Corruption Aura. Any healing magic cast within 30 feet of Lyralei heals for the minimum amount on the dice.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If Lyranei fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

Magic Resistance. Lyranei has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Actions Multiattack. Lyranei makes two Corrupted Touch attacks or casts a spell and makes one Corrupted Touch attack.

Corrupted Touch. Melee Spell Attack: +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) necrotic damage, and the target must make a DC 18 Constitution saving throw or have their maximum hit points reduced by the damage dealt.

Knowledge Drain (Recharge 5-6). Lyranei targets one creature within 60 feet. The target must make a DC 18 Intelligence saving throw. On a failed save, the creature takes 21 (6d6) psychic damage and Lyranei regains 10 hit points. On a successful save, the creature takes half damage and Lyranei doesn't regain hit points.

Legendary Actions (2 per turn)

- **Move.** Lyranei moves up to her speed without provoking opportunity attacks.
- **Cantrip.** Lyranei casts a cantrip.
- **Corrupted Touch.** Lyranei makes one Corrupted Touch attack.
- **Phase Shift (Costs 2 Actions).** Lyranei becomes incorporeal until the start of her next turn.

Phase 2 Changes (at 50% hit points):

- Gains resistance to all damage except radiant
- Can cast spells as legendary actions
- Corruption Aura radius increases to 60 feet
- Gains *Harm* and *Circle of Death* spells

Phase 3 Changes (at 25% hit points):

- Becomes immobile but gains +2 AC
- All attacks become area effects (15-foot radius)
- Can use *Dominate Person* as a legendary action
- Room-wide darkness effect (magical darkness, 120-foot radius)

Wandering Monsters

Animated Book *Tiny construct, neutral*

- **Armor Class** 13 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 3 (1d4 + 1)

- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 30 ft.
- **STR** 4 (-3) **DEX** 16 (+3) **CON** 12 (+1) **INT** 1 (-5) **WIS** 5 (-3) **CHA** 1 (-5)
- **Damage Immunities** poison, psychic
- **Condition Immunities** blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
- **Senses** blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 7
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1/8 (25 XP)

Actions ***Slam.** Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 bludgeoning damage.

Crawling Claw *Tiny undead, neutral evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 2 (1d4)
- **Speed** 20 ft., climb 20 ft.
- **STR** 13 (+1) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 11 (+0) **INT** 5 (-3) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 4 (-3)
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, poisoned
- **Senses** blindsight 30 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 10
- **Languages** understands Common but can't speak
- **Challenge** 0 (10 XP)

Turn Immunity. The claw is immune to effects that turn undead.

Actions ***Claw.** Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) bludgeoning or slashing damage (claw's choice).

Will-o'-Wisp *Tiny undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 19
- **Hit Points** 22 (9d4)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 1 (-5) **DEX** 28 (+9) **CON** 10 (+0) **INT** 13 (+1) **WIS** 14 (+2) **CHA** 11 (+0)
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, fire, necrotic, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** lightning, poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, poisoned, prone, restrained, unconscious
- **Senses** darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 12
- **Languages** the languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 2 (450 XP)

Consume Life. As a bonus action, the will-o'-wisp can target one creature within 5 feet of it that has 0 hit points and is still alive. The target must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw

against this magic, taking 10 (3d6) necrotic damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. If this damage reduces the target to 0 hit points, the target dies, and the will-o'-wisp regains 10 (3d6) hit points.

Ephemeral. The will-o'-wisp can't wear or carry anything.

Incorporeal Movement. The will-o'-wisp can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Variable Illumination. The will-o'-wisp sheds bright light in a 5- to 20-foot radius and dim light for an additional number of feet equal to the chosen radius. The will-o'-wisp can alter the radius as a bonus action.

Actions Shock. *Melee Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (2d8) lightning damage.

Invisibility. The will-o'-wisp and its light magically become invisible until it attacks or uses its Consume Life, or until its concentration ends (as if concentrating on a spell).

Shadow *Medium undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 16 (3d8 + 3)
- **Speed** 40 ft.
- **STR** 6 (-2) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 13 (+1) **INT** 6 (-2) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 8 (-1)
- **Skills** Stealth +4 (+6 in dim light or darkness)
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** radiant
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** necrotic, poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1/2 (100 XP)

Amorphous. The shadow can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Shadow Stealth. While in dim light or darkness, the shadow can take the Hide action as a bonus action.

Sunlight Weakness. While in sunlight, the shadow has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws.

Actions Strength Drain. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) necrotic damage, and the target's Strength score is reduced by 1d4. The target dies if this

reduces its Strength to 0. Otherwise, the reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. If a non-evil humanoid dies from this attack, a new shadow rises from the corpse 1d4 hours later.

Poltergeist *Medium undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 22 (5d8)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 1 (-5) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 11 (+0) **INT** 10 (+0) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 11 (+0)
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** necrotic, poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** any languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 1 (200 XP)

Incorporeal Movement. The poltergeist can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the poltergeist has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions Life Drain. *Melee Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) necrotic damage. The target must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the target's hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

Forceful Slam. The poltergeist hurls a Small or smaller object within 60 feet at a creature. The target must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 10 (3d6) bludgeoning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Invisibility. The poltergeist magically turns invisible until it attacks, or until its concentration ends (as if concentrating on a spell). Any equipment the poltergeist wears or carries is invisible with it.

Tactical Considerations:

- Guardians activate one per round, giving party time to focus fire
- Each guardian has a weakness that observant characters can exploit
- Destroying the binding circles (AC 15, 25 HP each) frees guardians from corruption
- Freed guardians may aid the party or simply disappear, depending on party actions

Guardian Rewards:

- **Blessed Weapons:** Each freed guardian blesses one party member's weapon (+1 for remainder of adventure)
- **Divine Protection:** Resistance to necrotic damage for 24 hours
- **Sacred Knowledge:** Information about the final boss's abilities and weaknesses

Room 4B: The Antechamber of Sorrows *The final barrier before the inner sanctum, this room contains the preserved remains of those who tried to stop the priestess's ritual. Their spirits linger, seeking either vengeance or peace.*

The Spirits: 6 Restless Dead (use **Specter** stats but can be reasoned with)

- Each spirit has a different story of how they died trying to stop the ritual
- Can be convinced to aid the party with successful Persuasion (DC varies by approach)
- Provide different benefits based on how they're convinced to help

Spirit Interactions:

- **The Brave Knight:** Offers tactical advice and temporary HP if treated with honor
- **The Wise Scholar:** Provides information about puzzle solutions if asked respectfully
- **The Faithful Acolyte:** Grants blessing equivalent to *Bless* spell if shown religious devotion
- **The Grieving Parent:** Heals the party if convinced that justice will be served
- **The Betrayed Friend:** Reveals secret weaknesses if the party promises to remember the truth
- **The Innocent Child:** Provides pure-hearted blessing that protects against corruption

The Inner Sanctum

Room 4C: The Chamber of Eternal Night *The temple's heart has been transformed into a grotesque parody of its former glory. Where once stood an altar to knowledge and protection, now writhes a mass of crystallized shadow and corrupted starlight. At its center stands High Priestess Lyralei the Eternal, no longer fully human but not quite undead.*

Lyralei the Eternal (Corrupted High Priestess)

- AC 17 (Natural Armor + Robes), HP 112, Speed 30 ft., fly 60 ft.
- **Legendary Actions:** 2 per turn
- **Spellcasting:** 9th level caster, spell save DC 16
- **Corruption Aura:** Healing magic within 30 feet heals for minimum amounts
- **Immortal Fury:** Gains extra attacks when reduced to half hit points
- **Phase Shift:** Can become incorporeal for one round as a legendary action

Phase 1: The Priestess (Rounds 1-3)

- Uses spells and ranged attacks while staying near the altar
- Casts *Spiritual Weapon*, *Hold Person*, and *Inflict Wounds*

- Summons corrupted knowledge spirits to aid in combat
- Attempts to corrupt party members with dark wisdom

Phase 2: The Transformation (Rounds 4-6)

- At half hit points, merges partially with the altar
- Gains resistance to physical damage but vulnerability to radiant
- Room-wide effects: darkness, difficult terrain, random teleportation
- More powerful spells: *Harm*, *Banishment*, *Circle of Death*

Phase 3: The Desperate End (Rounds 7+)

- Fully merged with altar, immobile but extremely dangerous
- Continuous area effects and legendary actions
- Can only be damaged by destroying altar components
- Final attempt to possess party member as escape method

Environmental Features:

- **Corrupted Altar:** AC 18, 50 HP, provides cover and power to Lyrlei
- **Shadow Crystals:** Destroy to reduce Lyrlei's power (AC 15, 15 HP each, 6 total)
- **Starlight Wells:** Sources of radiant damage that can be redirected
- **Ritual Circles:** Can be disrupted to prevent reinforcements

Chapter 5: Resolution and Rewards

Cleansing the Sanctum

Immediate Aftermath: With Lyrlei's defeat, the corruption begins to fade from the temple. The party has several options for completing the cleansing:

Option 1: Ritual Purification

- Requires a character with divine spellcasting ability
- 1-hour ritual using components found throughout the temple
- Completely cleanses the corruption and restores the temple's holy nature
- Attracts the attention of Solara's remaining faithful

Option 2: Scholarly Restoration

- Requires successful Investigation and History checks
- Focus on preserving and organizing the knowledge within
- Creates a valuable research facility but doesn't fully cleanse the evil
- Attracts scholars and researchers from across the realm

Option 3: Sealed Destruction

- Use the original sealing ritual to lock away any remaining corruption
- Prevents the evil from spreading but doesn't save the temple
- Quick solution but sacrifices the potential benefits
- Ensures no future threats emerge from this location

Treasure and Rewards

Major Treasure Discoveries:

- **Lyrarei's Circlet:** Increases spell save DC by 1, grants immunity to charm
- **Tome of Sacred Knowledge:** Functions as a *Manual of Gainful Exercise* but for Wisdom
- **Staff of the Eternal:** +1 quarterstaff that can cast *Sanctuary* once per day
- **Robes of the Scholar:** AC 13 + Dex modifier, advantage on Investigation checks
- **5000 gp** worth of gems, artifacts, and precious metals scattered throughout

Temple Treasures by Location:

- **Level 1:** 500 gp equivalent in coins, potions, and minor magic items
- **Level 2:** Spell scrolls, books worth 1000 gp, knowledge-based magic items
- **Level 3:** Alchemical supplies worth 800 gp, experimental potions and elixirs
- **Level 4:** Corrupted treasures that can be purified, sacred relics worth 2000 gp

Experience Rewards:

- **Standard Combat XP:** For all creatures defeated
- **Puzzle Solving:** 100-200 XP per major puzzle solved
- **Roleplay Encounters:** 50-150 XP for successful negotiations with spirits
- **Exploration:** 25 XP per secret area discovered
- **Story Milestones:** 500 XP for reaching each new level, 1000 XP for final victory

Long-term Consequences

If the Temple is Fully Restored:

- Becomes a pilgrimage site and research center
- Party gains reputation with scholars and religious organizations
- Potential base of operations with library access and divine support
- Future adventures may involve protecting or expanding the temple's influence

If the Knowledge is Preserved:

- Establishes party as patrons of learning and discovery
- Access to rare information and magical research
- Attracts both allies and enemies interested in the temple's secrets
- Potential for academic adventures and scholarly conflicts

If the Temple is Sealed:

- Quick resolution but missed opportunities for greater rewards
- Local area becomes safer but less interesting
- Party's reputation focuses on practical problem-solving
- Future adventures may involve dealing with other sealed locations

Level Advancement

Recommended Progression:

- **Start:** Characters begin at 2nd level
- **After Level 1:** Advance to 3rd level
- **After Level 2:** Advance to 4th level
- **After Level 3:** Advance to 4th level (if not already there)
- **Final Victory:** Advance to 5th level

Milestone Advancement Triggers:

- Solving the Guardian Statue riddles
- Discovering the true history of the temple's corruption
- Successfully navigating the Hall of Mirrors
- Freeing the corrupted guardians
- Defeating Lyrlei and cleansing the corruption

Appendix A: Maps and Layouts

Level 1: Hall of Trials

- **Room 1A:** Guardian Statues - Entry challenge
- **Room 1B:** Purification Chamber - Blessing and preparation
- **Room 1C:** Archive Antechamber - Information gathering
- **Room 1D:** Defiled Study - Combat encounter
- **Room 1E:** Corrupted Garden - Environmental hazards

Level 2: Sacred Libraries

- **Room 2A:** Main Reading Hall - Major combat with animated books
- **Room 2B:** Scroll Vault - Puzzle and treasure chamber
- **Room 2C:** Forbidden Section - Dangerous knowledge and guardians

Level 3: Ritual Chambers

- **Room 3A:** Alchemical Laboratory - Environmental hazards and combat
- **Room 3B:** Meditation Circle - Mental challenges and spiritual tests
- **Room 3C:** Hall of Mirrors - Navigation puzzle and psychological challenges

Level 4: Corrupted Sanctum

- **Room 4A:** Guardian Chamber - Multiple enemy types with tactical options
- **Room 4B:** Antechamber of Sorrows - Roleplay encounter with spirits
- **Room 4C:** Inner Sanctum - Final boss fight with environmental elements

Appendix B: Random Encounters

Wandering Monsters (Roll d8 when party makes excessive noise)

1. **2 Animated Books** seeking to return to the library
2. **1 Corrupted Scholar** lost and confused, potentially helpful
3. **3 Crawling Claws** from defeated undead reassembling
4. **1 Will-o'-Wisp** drawn to magical energy use
5. **2 Shadows** seeping through walls from deeper levels
6. **1 Poltergeist** (use **Specter** stats) throwing objects around
7. **Magical Surge:** Wild magic effect from unstable temple energy
8. **Helpful Spirit:** Friendly ghost provides warning or assistance

Environmental Hazards

- **Unstable Floors:** DC 15 Perception to notice, DC 12 Dex save or fall 10 feet
- **Magical Darkness:** Mundane light sources don't work in affected areas
- **Memory Echoes:** DC 13 Wisdom save or experience traumatic temple memories
- **Teleportation Traps:** Random transportation to different temple areas
- **Silence Zones:** Areas where sound cannot be made or heard
- **Time Distortion:** Rounds last longer or shorter than normal

Adventure Credits

- **Design:** Classic dungeon crawl emphasizing exploration, puzzles, and tactical combat
- **Estimated Play Time:** 8-12 hours across 2-3 sessions
- **Recommended Party Size:** 4-6 characters
- **Level Range:** 2-4

DM's Notes: This adventure provides a complete dungeon experience with multiple types of challenges. Each level has a distinct theme and escalating difficulty. Encourage players to explore thoroughly and reward creative problem-solving. The temple's history should be revealed gradually through environmental storytelling, found documents, and NPC interactions. Balance combat encounters with puzzle-solving and roleplay opportunities to maintain engagement for all player types.